Report sports performance and price sponsorships on engaged views.

MEASURED

Across 746 sports channels, long-form videos published August 31 to September 29 had 74% more first-month public views per video (+60% to +94%) than the same channels' summer videos. Some of that may be real growth.

SEASON OR COUNT?

Basketball and hockey rose alongside football and soccer before the NBA and NHL openers: imperfect checks, since basketball includes the WNBA playoffs and hockey training camps. No sport showed a clear Shorts rise.

NOT MEASURED

Engaged views, the old count. Each channel sees them in YouTube Studio; this analysis could not.

- Monday, reporting: compare first-30-day engaged views at matching competition stages with 2025; label public views separately (slide 7).
- Monday, sponsorships: for your 10 most recent sponsored long-form videos since August 24 now 30 days old, divide total engaged by total public views; use that share with an agreed engaged CPM (slide 8).

On August 24 YouTube changed what a view is, at the start of the busiest stretch of the sports calendar

Before

A view needed a viewer to keep watching

YouTube never published how long. That count is now called “engaged views” and is available in the creator’s YouTube Studio and through authorized channel reporting.

After

A view counts when the video starts

Any play counts, including a few seconds of autoplay in a feed. Shorts already counted this way. Counts from before August 24 were not restated.

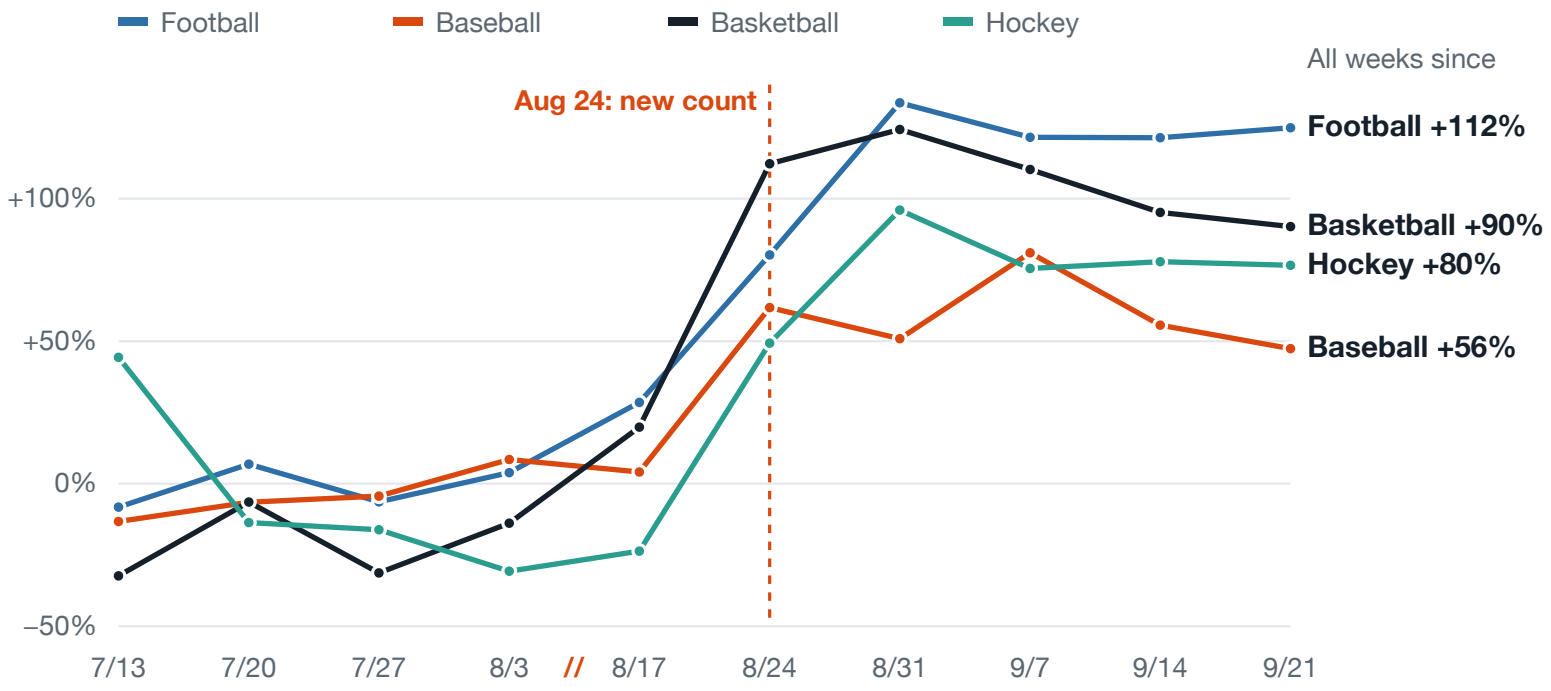
Kickoff

Bad timing for sports

The American football and European soccer seasons were starting. Fall is when sports channels report season starts against last year, so a counting change is easy to read as a great start. Last year these weeks showed no long-form rise, a weak check (appendix A15).

Different sports calendars, the same week of rising public views

Each line is one sport's new long-form videos by publish week, read at one month old, against the same channels' videos from before the change.



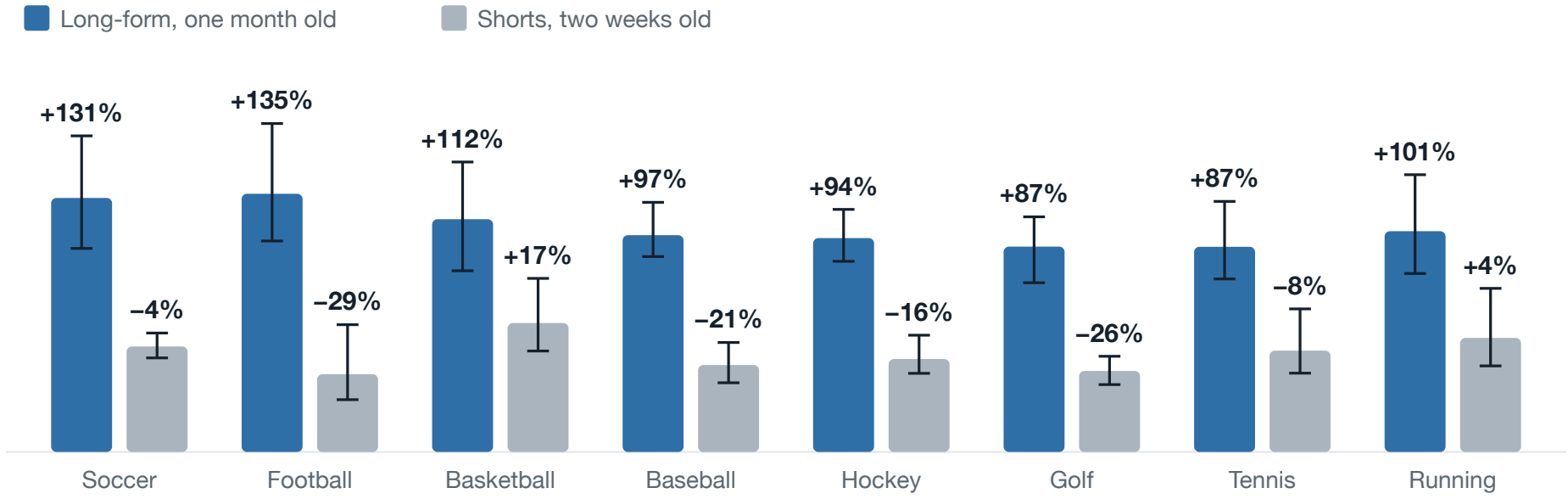
COULD IT BE THE SEASON?

Football starting, baseball nearing the postseason, NBA and NHL openers still ahead, yet all four rose the same week. Basketball includes the WNBA playoffs and hockey training camps, so neither is a season-free control. That supports, but does not isolate or size, a counting contribution.

Change in views per video against each channel's earlier videos; late July to mid-August publishes straddle the change, and the thin August 10 week is left out. End labels pool every week since the change, as on slide 5. Soccer and all sports: appendix A3 and A4. *Source: sport_event_study.csv.*

Same sports, same weeks: long-form rose in all eight. Shorts, whose counting did not change, rose clearly in none

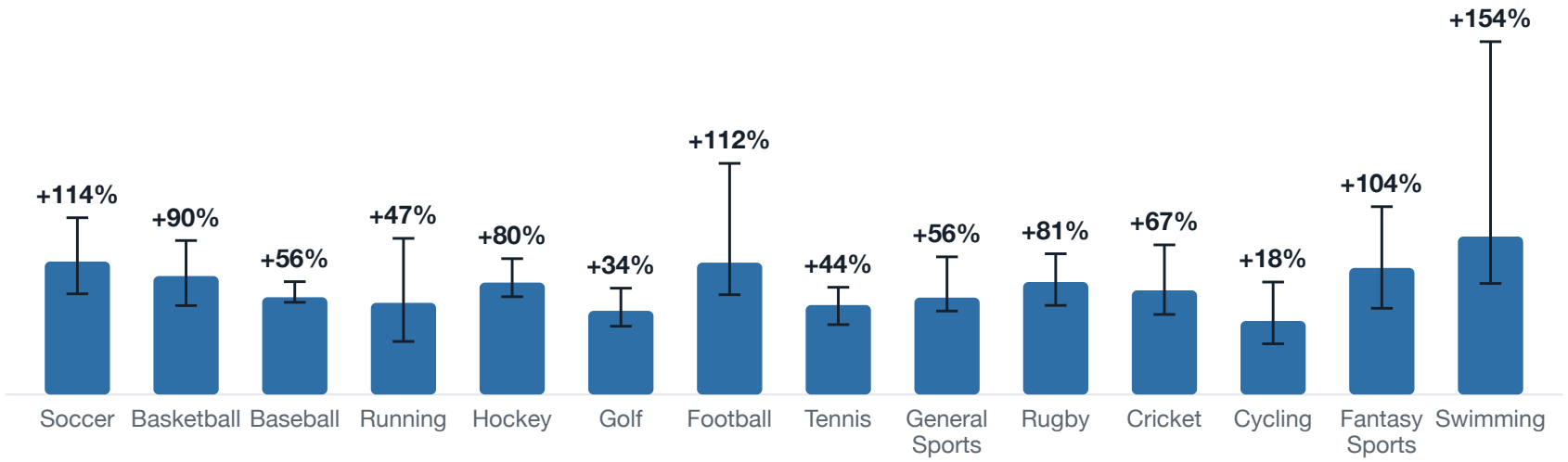
On the typical video, long-form rose +87% to +135% in all eight sports. Shorts, counted the same way before and after, ran –29% to +17%. Shorts are a different format, read at 12 to 14 days, so this weighs against a season-wide surge without ruling one out. Shorts fell on the typical video (0.91x, 0.84x to 0.99x); if viewers moved from Shorts to long-form, part of the long-form rise is real viewing, which this analysis cannot separate.



Typical video (geometric mean), so one big channel cannot dominate; slides 3 and 5 use views per video, so football reads +135% here and +112% there. Bar height is views after ÷ before for the same channels; labels show the change, and lines the range from channel sampling. Sports with at least 20 Shorts channels. *Source: lift_by_segment.csv.*

Every sport's typical video rose; on views per video, running and cycling are within noise. Do not sell any one as the biggest gainer

Long-form views at one month old, each sport's channels against their own earlier videos. Soccer ran above its own baseline in July, during the World Cup, and spiked again in the Sept 7 week, so do not read its +114% as counting alone (appendix A3). Between seasons, 97% of hockey channels rose, against about 50% in a smaller no-change sample (A6). Named channels ran from 1.00x (Manchester United, range 0.43x to 2.66x) to 12.76x (ESPN College Football, whose summer had no games): price each creator on their own engaged share (A7).



On the typical video all 14 sports rose, 1.39x to 2.35x (A16). Sorted by number of channels, largest first. Bar height is views after ÷ before; labels show the change, and lines the range from channel sampling. Channels per sport range from 14 to 171. *Source: lift_by_segment.csv.*

Cross-season public-view records mix two counts. Post-change videos are overrepresented in this sample's top 1,000

+74%

New videos vs the same creators' summer videos

A new video's first month runs far above the same creator's earlier videos. Any recap that compares this fall with last fall on public views mixes two counts.

77%

Of the top 1,000 videos

Among long-form videos published May 8 to July 26 or August 31 to September 29, each at one month old, those after the change are 64% of uploads but 77% of the 1,000 most viewed. A uniform 1.74x adjustment cuts their share to 61%: a sensitivity to counting, not a measured correction. The windows also differ by season, summer against early fall, so part of the gap may be season.

No blanket correction

Don't apply the 74% rise as a discount across your whole channel

Older videos contain views counted under different rules, and this study does not measure engaged views. For Monday's report, show first-30-day engaged views against matching competition stages in 2025, and label public views separately. Lifetime-total scenarios are in appendix A18.

For sports creators, clubs, and leagues: report the season on engaged views, and label every count

Measured on 746 sports channels, including league and club channels, which ranged from no clear change (NBA, Manchester United) to 9.11x (Major League Soccer, whose summer baseline overlapped the World Cup) (appendix A7). Shorts already used the new rule, so keep long-form and Shorts separate and measure your own gap before estimating a whole-channel effect. Compare engaged views with matching 2025 weeks and competition stages; show public views only beside engaged views, both labeled.

1. Season recaps by sport

Report line: “[stage, format]: X first-30-day engaged views, Y% vs the matching 2025 stage; public views Z, new count.” Football: weeks 1 to 4. MLB: same postseason rounds. Soccer: match stages; July’s World Cup is a different baseline. NBA and NHL: openers pending until day 30.

2. Rate cards and media kits

Name the count behind every number. New videos average 1.74x the public views of the same channels’ summer videos (1.60x to 1.94x), including any real growth. Among the 480 channels with five or more videos on each side, about 22% moved less than 1.25x and 11% more than 4x. These are observed changes and don’t measure the counting effect (appendix A5). Before a sponsor asks, put your own day-30 public and engaged views side by side, and quote engaged first.

3. Records and rankings

Label records set after August 24 as records under the new count. Football’s opening weeks and the October NBA and NHL openers use a different count from 2025; before claiming a cross-season record, compare engaged views at the same video age.

Selling sponsorships: agree a CPM per 1,000 engaged views; convert public-view requests with each creator's measured engaged share

Fee = views × share ÷ 1,000 × CPM

Public views × engaged share ÷ 1,000 × engaged-view CPM; e.g. 1,000,000 × 70% ÷ 1,000 × $30 = $21,000. Engaged share is each creator's day-30 engaged ÷ public views in YouTube Studio; this study could not see it. Keep an existing engaged-view rate; agree metric and rate before renewing a public-view contract

For a guarantee, agree an engaged-view target and reconcile against actual engaged views

$21,000

Hypothetical 70% engaged share: 1 million public views hold 700,000 engaged views. Paying $30,000 means a $42.86 engaged-view CPM; at an agreed $30, the fee is $21,000, $9,000 less

The 70% share is hypothetical; substitute the creator's measured share

Do not use 1 ÷ 1.74 to price a creator. Your engaged share: take your 10 most recent sponsored long-form videos published since August 24 that have reached day 30, and divide total engaged by total public views over each one's first 30 days; disclose a smaller sample, and report Shorts separately. Football and soccer: base guarantees on comparable competition stages. NBA and NHL: mark opener guarantees provisional and rebase in late November, when October videos reach day 30 (A2). Packages: long-form and Shorts separately; the 74% is long-form only.

What would change this read, and when to look

Late November 2026

October videos, published as the NBA and NHL seasons start, reach one month old. Recheck the rise, and ask creators for public and engaged counts on the same videos. So far the Sept 7 week spiked to +106%, led by soccer (appendix A3); the Sept 21 week, at +64%, is back near the Aug 31 week (+67%), and videos from Sept 14 on run 11% below the first two post-change weeks (appendix A15).

What would settle it

What would settle it: public and engaged views on the same videos from a representative set of sports creators, matched by age. What we have: 19 re-cuts of public views all show a rise (+46% to +85%, appendix A17); none of them sees engaged views. Unexplained: the full step starts with videos published August 27, not August 24 (appendix A14).

The assumption

The evidence points to counting, but we cannot yet split the rise between counting and real viewing growth. The 74% rise cannot tell a creator's engaged share or sponsorship discount: request public and engaged counts on the same sponsored videos, and agree the engaged-view CPM separately. Last year's same weeks, the only long-form check that spans a season start, showed no rise (0.88x, 0.72x to 1.10x), though video ages differ widely (appendix A15).

Who made this

Patrick Morris made this at Sporting Works using aftergrid, open-source analytics skills for the AI agent you already use. Spot Sports' catalog has 1,070 sports creator channels, 1,040 of them with an assigned sport across 18 sports. 746 channels in 14 sports met the analysis bar.

About Patrick · Email · aftergrid on GitHub · How this analysis was built

APPENDIX

Sport and channel detail

Each page is a view of one file in analysis/results/. Ratios are after ÷ before. Ranges are 95% intervals from resampling channels.

A1. Soccer and basketball hold 36% of long-form views; football's 62 channels draw as much as baseball's 96

Sport	Channels	Videos	Long-form share	Median long-form length	Share of long-form views
Soccer	209	112,291	52%	10 min	20.6%
Basketball	119	76,650	50%	14 min	15.4%
Running	117	19,963	63%	12 min	2.6%
Baseball	96	50,613	54%	13 min	8.8%
Hockey	94	40,588	55%	10 min	2.1%
Golf	79	15,826	49%	17 min	6.5%
Football	62	47,135	61%	16 min	8.8%
Rugby	47	11,389	46%	26 min	0.6%
General Sports	38	84,353	48%	10 min	15.7%
Tennis	36	25,558	55%	8 min	5.4%
Cricket	29	7,701	53%	18 min	4.6%
Swimming	28	5,589	42%	11 min	0.2%
Fantasy Sports	21	5,545	78%	52 min	0.2%
Cycling	20	11,390	39%	9 min	2.4%
Volleyball	19	3,854	83%	13 min	1.7%
Lacrosse	12	2,614	37%	18 min	0.0%
Motorsports	9	4,546	29%	23 min	1.6%
Combat	5	8,418	28%	13 min	2.8%

Each channel is assigned its most common sport. Views are stored public counts at the last reading, all ages. Sports with fewer than 10 analyzable channels (volleyball, lacrosse, motorsports, combat) are not in slides 3 to 9. *Source: sport_catalog.csv.*

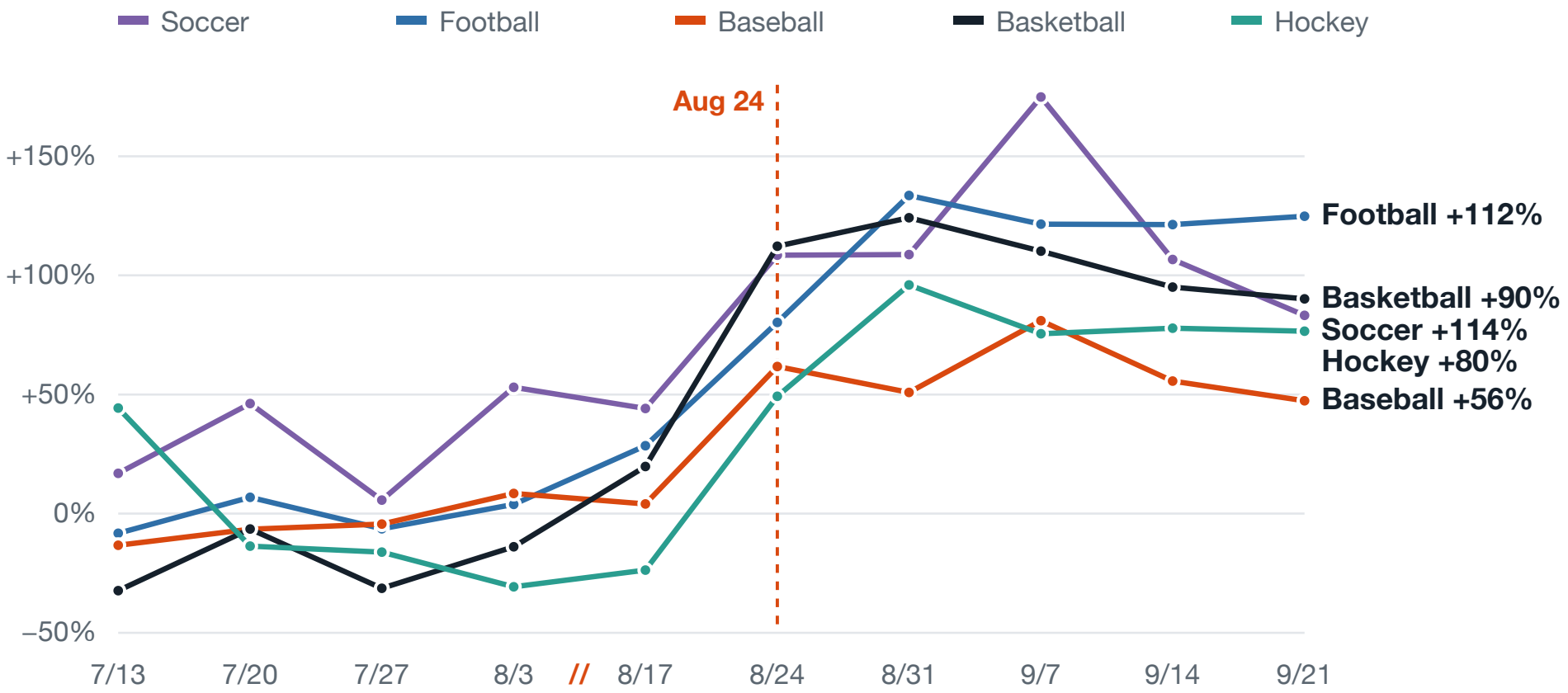
A2. Where each sport stood when the count changed, how much it rose, and the first fair comparison with 2025

Sport	August 24 to September 21	Rise, views per video	First like-for-like comparison with 2025, on engaged views
Football	Season starting: college kickoff, then the NFL	+112%	Weeks 1 to 4 of each season, same video age
Basketball	NBA between seasons; WNBA playoffs	+90%	October openers against last October’s
Hockey	NHL between seasons; training camps	+80%	October openers against last October’s
Baseball	Final month of the regular season	+56%	Postseason rounds against last year’s same rounds
Soccer	European leagues starting; summer was World Cup season	+114%	Same competition stage, not July
All sports	Shorts counting unchanged	+74%	Long-form only; ask for Shorts separately

Calendar positions are general knowledge, not data in this extract. Use first-30-day engaged views from YouTube Studio for this comparison. *Source: sports calendar; lift_by_segment.csv.*

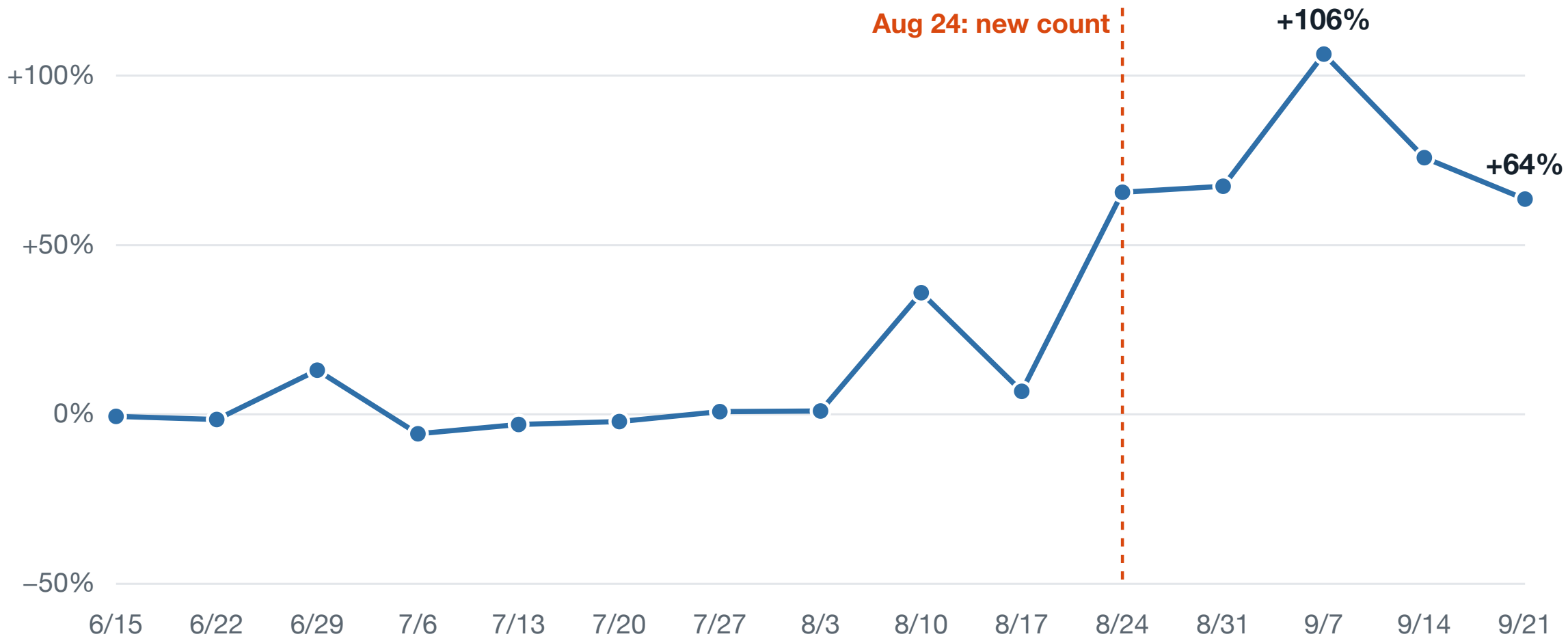
A3. The weekly rise in the five largest sports

Soccer was already above its baseline in July, during the World Cup's final weeks: do not read its full +114% pooled rise as counting, or use it as a soccer pricing discount. Football's season start coincides with the change; basketball and hockey avoid the NBA and NHL regular-season starts, but other calendar changes remain possible contributors.



Views per video at one month old against each channel's pre-change level. The thin August 10 week is left out. *Source: sport_event_study.csv.*

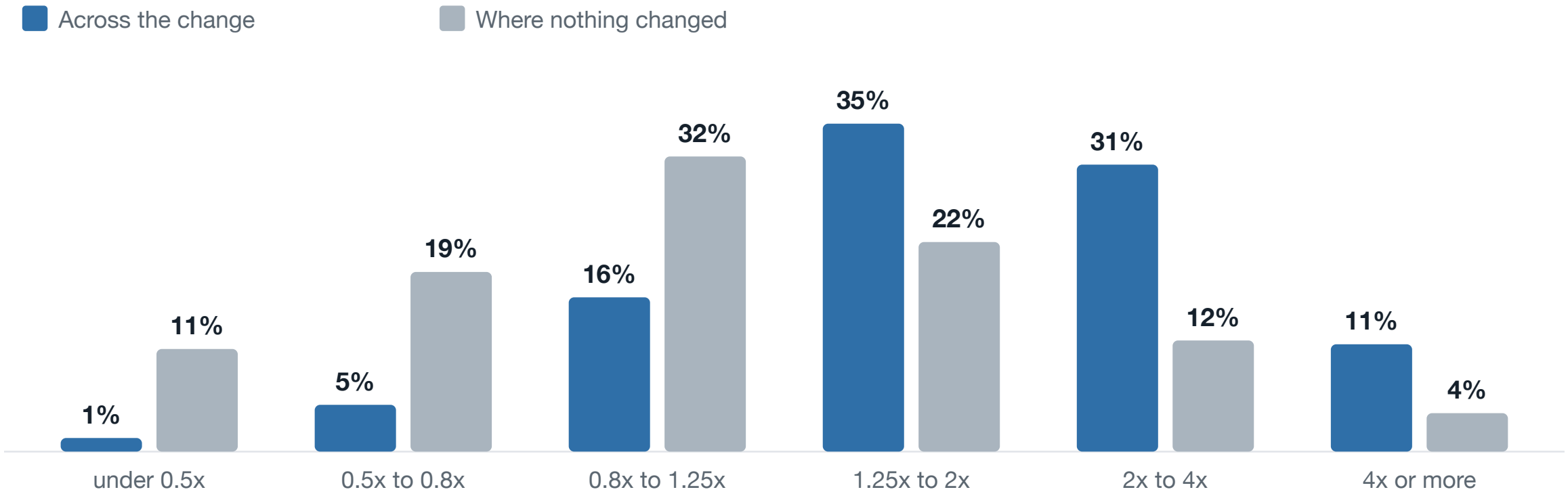
A4. The weekly rise, all sports



Weeks before 7/20 were read before the change; 23% of the 7/20 week was read just after it; 7/27 to 8/17 straddle it. *Source: event_study.csv.*

A5. Channel by channel: how much each channel's new videos changed

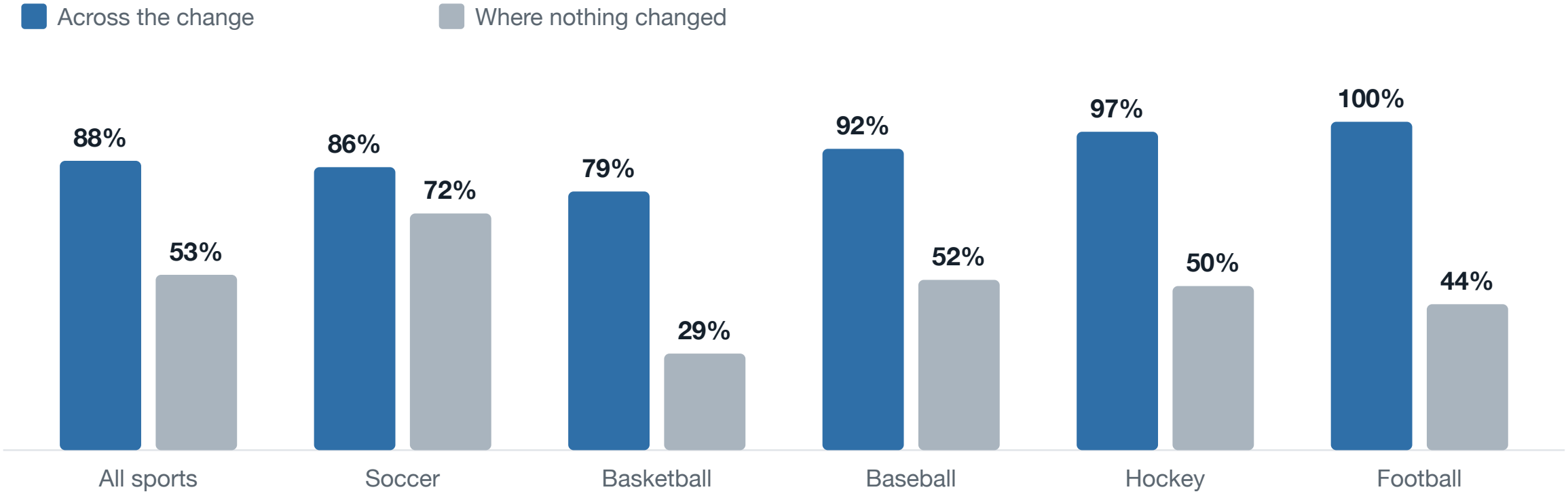
One ratio per channel with at least 5 videos on each side: 480 channels across the change. Where nothing changed, channels center on no change; across the change, most moved up.



Share of channels in each band of mean views per new video over mean views per earlier video, at 28 to 30 days. Where nothing changed: published before vs after July 1, all read before August 24. *Source: channel_lift_distribution.csv.*

A6. Between seasons, 97% of hockey channels and 79% of basketball channels rose. Football's 100% coincides with kickoff

Share of channels whose new videos rose, across the change against a period where nothing changed. Audit season reports across every channel, including those without a breakout. This shows how widespread the rise is and doesn't measure each channel's counting effect. Football: 35 of 49 analyzed channels had 5 or more videos on each side.



Channels with at least 5 videos on each side. Where nothing changed, sports have 14 to 43 channels each, so their shares are rough. *Source: channel_lift_summary.csv.*

A7. Named channels moved from 1.00x (Manchester United) to 12.76x (ESPN College Football): schedules and counting mix at the channel level (1 of 2)

Sport	Channel	Videos before / after	New over earlier videos (range)
Soccer	FC Barcelona	31 / 43	3.83x (2.30x to 6.53x)
Soccer	CBS Sports Golazo	171 / 314	2.66x (1.85x to 3.59x)
Soccer	ESPN FC	270 / 218	2.06x (1.47x to 2.82x)
Soccer	Manchester United	26 / 60	1.00x (0.43x to 2.66x)
Soccer	Major League Soccer	82 / 183	9.11x (4.77x to 17.94x)
Basketball	NBA	156 / 67	1.14x (0.62x to 2.03x)
Basketball	FIBA Basketball	368 / 370	2.32x (1.71x to 3.17x)
Basketball	Club 520 Podcast	71 / 90	1.12x (0.86x to 1.47x)
Basketball	First Things First	74 / 107	3.54x (2.82x to 4.49x)
Basketball	Gil's Arena	19 / 53	3.58x (2.82x to 4.53x)
Baseball	MLB	468 / 793	1.51x (1.27x to 1.83x)
Baseball	Jomboy Media	7 / 10	2.22x (1.38x to 3.53x)
Baseball	Los Angeles Dodgers	8 / 25	1.25x (0.84x to 2.06x)
Baseball	ESPN MLB	45 / 45	1.19x (0.62x to 2.28x)
Baseball	Fuzzy	19 / 26	1.47x (1.25x to 1.72x)

Source: channel_examples.csv.

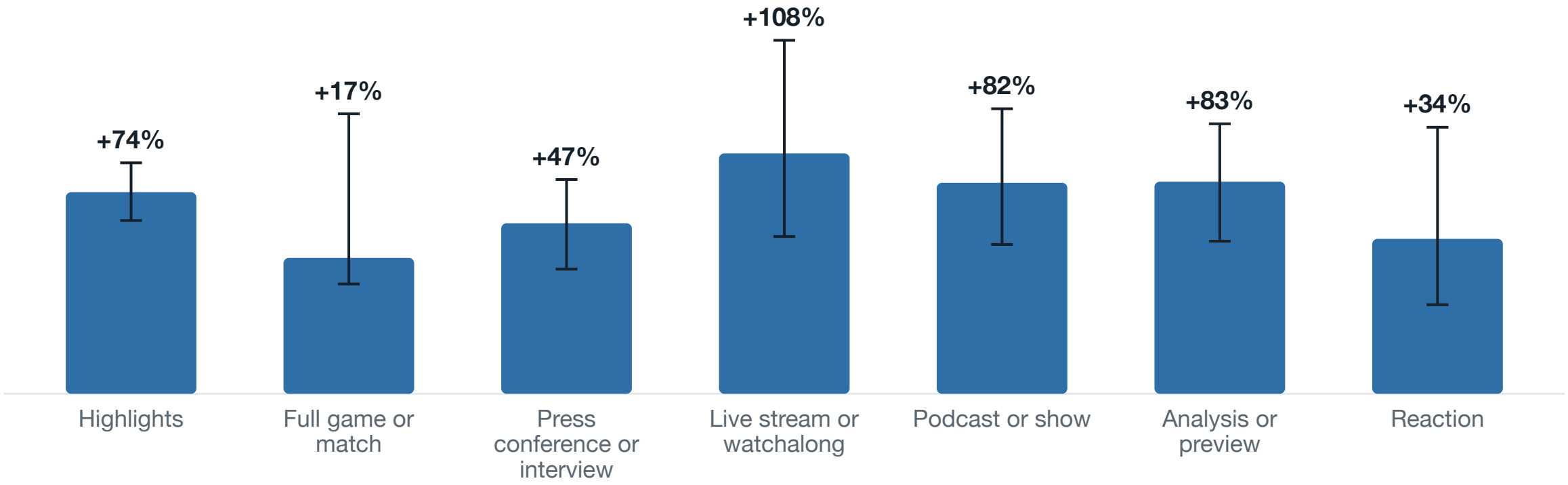
A7. Named channels moved from 1.00x (Manchester United) to 12.76x (ESPN College Football): schedules and counting mix at the channel level (2 of 2)

Sport	Channel	Videos before / after	New over earlier videos (range)
Hockey	NHL	43 / 112	1.82x (1.15x to 3.49x)
Hockey	The Hockey Guy	78 / 95	1.77x (1.44x to 2.20x)
Hockey	sdpn	52 / 85	1.28x (0.97x to 1.75x)
Hockey	NBC Sports Philadelphia	45 / 97	1.78x (1.18x to 2.87x)
Hockey	Edmonton Oilers	14 / 70	2.19x (1.06x to 5.87x)
Football	ESPN College Football	52 / 498	12.76x (9.19x to 18.51x)
Football	Nightcap	101 / 223	1.30x (1.08x to 1.54x)
Football	NFL on ESPN	73 / 308	2.66x (1.96x to 3.60x)
Football	Speakeasy	81 / 228	1.43x (1.19x to 1.68x)
Football	NFL on NBC	129 / 552	1.75x (1.38x to 2.26x)

The five largest channels by stored long-form views in each of the five largest sports, with at least 5 videos on each side at 28 to 30 days. Mean views per new video over mean per earlier video; ranges resample each channel's videos. A channel whose summer had no games, such as college football, mixes its season start with the count; Major League Soccer's before window overlaps the World Cup summer. Use: ask each of these for its engaged share before renewing a package. *Source: channel_examples.csv.*

A8. Five of seven title-tagged formats rose clearly; full game or match and reaction are within noise. No format is shown to differ

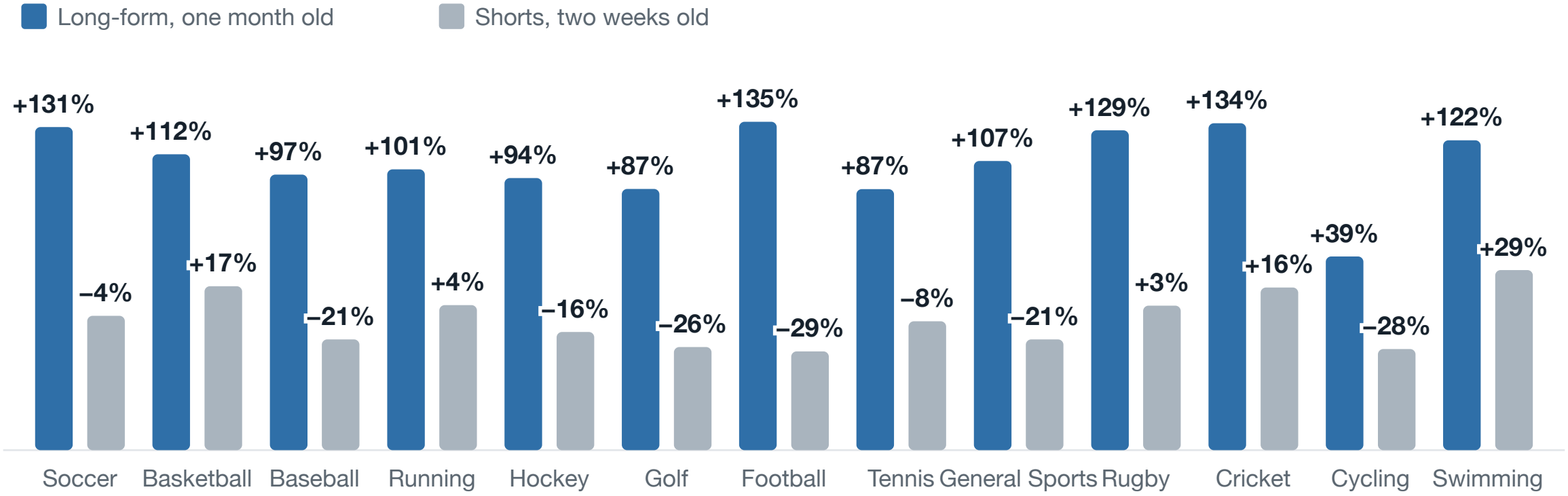
Long-form videos tagged from their titles, all sports. Live streams and watchalongs rose +108%; press conferences and interviews +47%; the ranges overlap. Use each creator's engaged share to price formats.



Keyword rules on video titles, applied in the order shown; most long-form videos match no rule and are left out. Each format compares the same channels' tagged videos before and after; formats with at least 10 such channels. Video titles are not published. *Source: format_lift.csv.*

A9. Long-form rose in every sport; Shorts did not clearly rise in any, and basketball Shorts are mixed (+17% typical, −61% views per video)

Basketball Shorts give opposite signals, +17% on the typical video but –61% on views per video, so a basketball package needs its own Shorts forecast. Football's typical long-form rose +135% while its Shorts fell 29%; hockey +94% and –16%. Do not promise Shorts delivery from long-form growth; set package guarantees from each creator's counts by format.



Bar height is views after ÷ before on the typical video. Sports with at least 10 Shorts channels; ranges are in appendix A16. *Source: lift_by_segment.csv.*

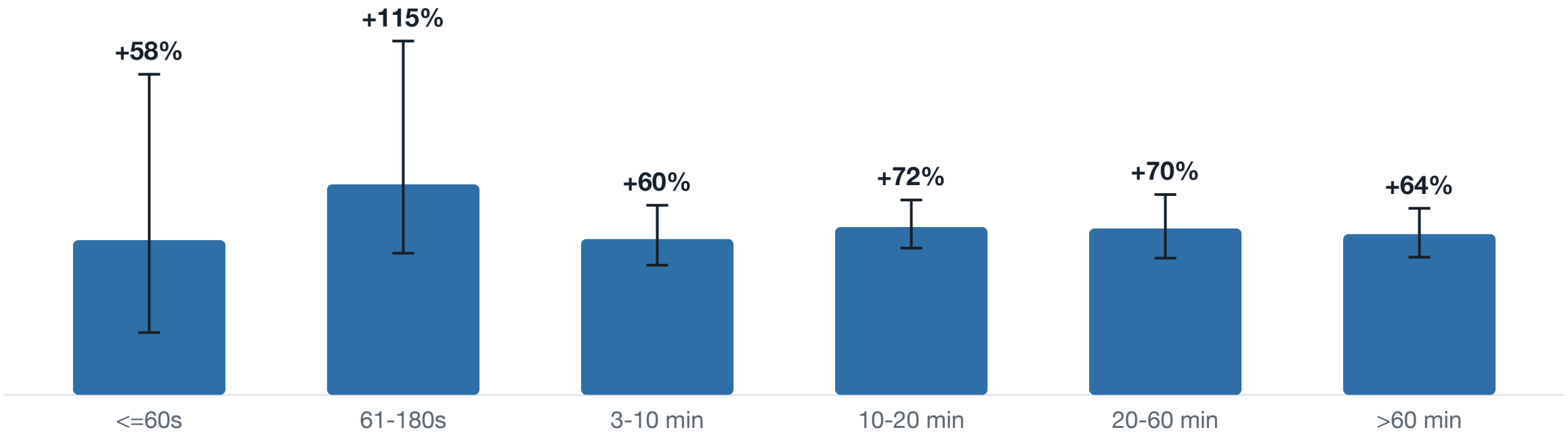
A10. Average within-week percentile shifts were small (-1.5 to +3.7 points); individual ranking stability is not established

Sport	Across the change	Nothing changed: July 1 split	Nothing changed: Sept 14 split
Baseball	+1.0	-1.6	+1.2
Basketball	+2.2	-3.6	-3.6
Cricket	+3.7	-3.9	+0.8
Cycling	-1.5	+6.0	+7.9
Fantasy Sports	+1.5	-1.2	+1.0
Football	+3.1	-1.6	+3.5
General Sports	+2.8	-0.3	+1.1
Golf	+0.7	-0.2	+2.9
Hockey	+1.2	-0.6	+2.1
Rugby	+3.5	+2.6	+2.5
Running	+1.9	-3.4	+3.1
Soccer	+2.3	+3.9	+1.6
Swimming	+0.3	-3.9	+4.7
Tennis	+0.6	-1.0	+2.7

For a ranking, hold sport, format, video age, and count definition constant; average shifts can hide large individual moves. Shift in each sport's average percentile within its publish week, in points. Spread across sports: 1.4 at the change against 2.5 to 3.0 where nothing changed. *Source: trial_rank_check.csv.*

A11. By video length: no length is shown to gain more than another

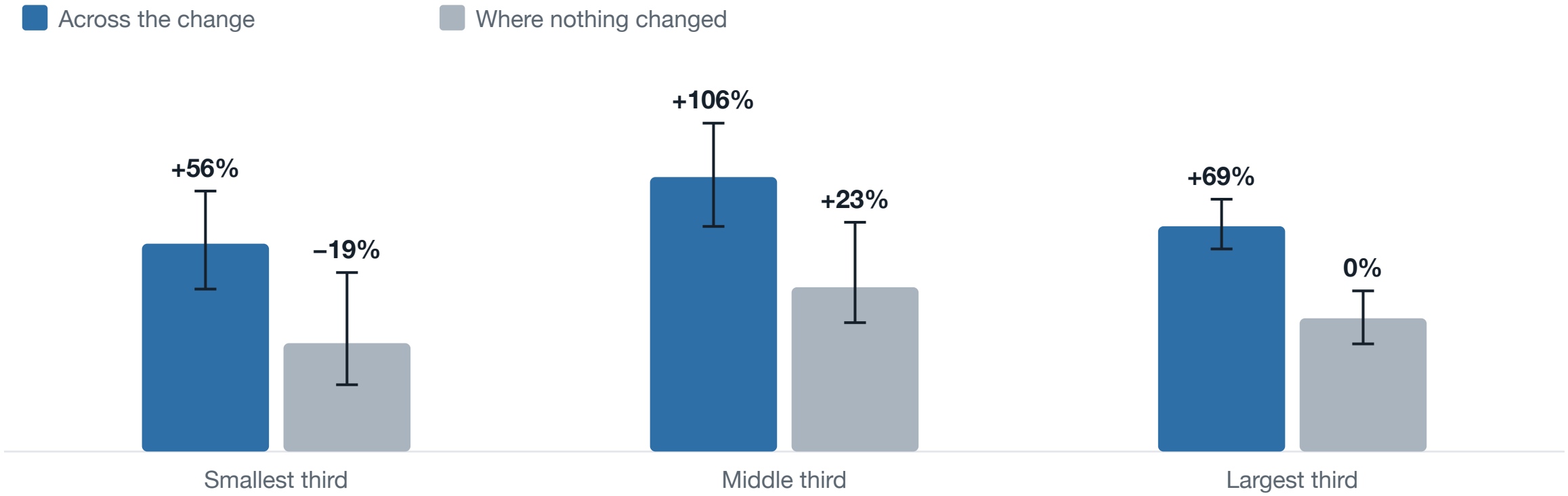
One-to-three-minute videos rose most, but differences between lengths are not established, and length does not identify format; for formats tagged from titles, see appendix A8.



Long-form views per video at one month old, against the same channels' earlier videos of that length. Lines show the range from channel sampling. *Source: lift_by_segment.csv.*

A12. Every size third rose; the middle third also rose 23% in a separate no-change window

The middle third rose 106% across the change and 23% in a separate no-change window. That warns against reading its full rise as counting; it does not measure how much was drift. Use each creator’s measured engaged share.



Size is each channel’s median lifetime views on long-form videos published January to April 2026, which sit outside both groups. Bar height is views after ÷ before. *Source: lift_by_segment.csv.*

APPENDIX

Method checks

How the headline was measured and tested: both measures, the transition weeks, the no-change comparisons, segments, sensitivity, and lifetime totals.

A13. The typical video rose 2.13x; views per video rose 1.74x

Comparison	Views per video	Typical video	Channels	Videos before / after
Long-form, 28 to 30 days old	1.74x (1.60x to 1.94x)	2.13x (1.96x to 2.31x)	746	13,254 / 23,962
Shorts, 12 to 14 days old	0.85x (0.62x to 1.08x)	0.91x (0.84x to 0.99x)	554	39,485 / 28,742

Views per video weights each channel's videos by their views. Typical video uses the log of views, so small videos count as much as hits. Ranges are 95% channel-resampling intervals. They assume viewing otherwise held steady. *Source: primary_lift.csv.*

A14. The step arrived with August 27 publishes, three days after the switch

Published	Views per video	Typical video	Channels	Videos
7/27 to 8/9	1.01x (0.83x to 1.24x)	1.07x (1.00x to 1.15x)	688	7,775
8/10 to 8/19	1.19x (0.94x to 1.56x)	1.11x (1.01x to 1.23x)	541	2,663
8/20 to 8/23	1.05x (0.85x to 1.30x)	1.29x (1.15x to 1.49x)	527	2,562
8/24 to 8/26	1.19x (1.03x to 1.39x)	1.29x (1.19x to 1.40x)	522	2,181
8/27 to 8/30	1.99x (1.69x to 2.34x)	2.37x (2.07x to 2.79x)	546	3,200
Aug 31 on	1.74x (1.59x to 1.94x)	2.13x (1.97x to 2.31x)	746	23,962

Why the full step starts with August 27 publishes, not August 24, is unknown. *Source: transition_lift.csv.*

A15. Where counting held still, views moved 0.85x to 0.97x, not 1.74x

Comparison	Views per video	Typical video	Channels	Counted as no-change
Long-form, after vs before July 1 (old rule)	0.96x (0.79x to 1.20x)	1.05x (0.97x to 1.15x)	623	Yes
Long-form, Sept 14 on vs Aug 31 to Sept 13 (new rule)	0.89x (0.81x to 0.97x)	0.95x (0.88x to 1.00x)	757	Check only: fell
Shorts, after vs before May 1	0.97x (0.80x to 1.19x)	1.03x (0.96x to 1.10x)	341	Yes
Shorts across the change (rule unchanged)	0.85x (0.62x to 1.08x)	0.91x (0.84x to 0.99x)	554	Yes
Shorts across the change, without its largest channel	0.99x (0.88x to 1.11x)	0.91x (0.83x to 0.99x)	553	Check only
Long-form, same weeks in 2025 (unequal ages)	0.88x (0.72x to 1.10x)	0.70x (0.37x to 0.97x)	335	Check only
Shorts, same weeks in 2025 (unequal ages)	2.42x (0.61x to 7.66x)	1.03x (0.87x to 1.27x)	48	Check only

Source: null_comparisons.csv.

A16. Every sport’s typical long-form video rose 1.39x to 2.35x; no sport’s typical Short rose more than 1.29x (1 of 2)

Group	Segment	Views per video	Typical video	Channels
Long-form, sport	Soccer	2.14x (1.62x to 2.84x)	2.31x (1.85x to 2.87x)	171
Long-form, sport	Basketball	1.90x (1.43x to 2.47x)	2.12x (1.65x to 2.64x)	93
Long-form, sport	Baseball	1.56x (1.48x to 1.81x)	1.97x (1.78x to 2.27x)	85
Long-form, sport	Running	1.47x (0.85x to 2.51x)	2.01x (1.62x to 2.52x)	68
Long-form, sport	Hockey	1.80x (1.57x to 2.18x)	1.94x (1.73x to 2.21x)	58
Long-form, sport	Golf	1.34x (1.10x to 1.71x)	1.87x (1.54x to 2.14x)	55
Long-form, sport	Football	2.12x (1.60x to 3.71x)	2.35x (1.92x to 2.99x)	49
Long-form, sport	Tennis	1.44x (1.12x to 1.72x)	1.87x (1.57x to 2.28x)	28
Long-form, sport	General Sports	1.56x (1.34x to 2.21x)	2.07x (1.68x to 2.50x)	25
Long-form, sport	Rugby	1.81x (1.43x to 2.26x)	2.29x (1.79x to 2.84x)	24
Long-form, sport	Cricket	1.67x (1.29x to 2.40x)	2.34x (1.83x to 3.04x)	19
Long-form, sport	Cycling	1.18x (0.81x to 1.81x)	1.39x (1.12x to 1.95x)	19
Long-form, sport	Fantasy Sports	2.04x (1.38x to 3.02x)	2.05x (1.39x to 3.00x)	14
Long-form, sport	Swimming	2.54x (1.78x to 5.67x)	2.22x (1.67x to 3.66x)	14
Shorts, sport	Soccer	1.23x (0.96x to 1.54x)	0.96x (0.86x to 1.08x)	135

Source: lift_by_segment.csv, segment_dispersion.csv.

A16. Every sport’s typical long-form video rose 1.39x to 2.35x; no sport’s typical Short rose more than 1.29x (2 of 2)

Group	Segment	Views per video	Typical video	Channels
Shorts, sport	Basketball	0.39x (0.21x to 1.35x)	1.17x (0.92x to 1.58x)	70
Shorts, sport	Hockey	0.73x (0.62x to 1.35x)	0.84x (0.72x to 1.06x)	56
Shorts, sport	Baseball	0.70x (0.57x to 0.90x)	0.79x (0.63x to 1.00x)	53
Shorts, sport	Golf	0.96x (0.59x to 1.27x)	0.74x (0.61x to 0.87x)	40
Shorts, sport	Running	0.88x (0.67x to 1.56x)	1.04x (0.78x to 1.49x)	36
Shorts, sport	Football	0.89x (0.52x to 1.58x)	0.71x (0.48x to 1.16x)	34
Shorts, sport	General Sports	0.92x (0.70x to 1.19x)	0.79x (0.60x to 1.16x)	27
Shorts, sport	Tennis	1.52x (0.88x to 2.75x)	0.92x (0.72x to 1.30x)	23
Shorts, sport	Rugby	1.14x (0.86x to 1.92x)	1.03x (0.74x to 1.59x)	17
Shorts, sport	Cycling	0.76x (0.55x to 0.85x)	0.72x (0.59x to 0.92x)	13
Shorts, sport	Swimming	2.00x (0.97x to 5.37x)	1.29x (0.98x to 1.89x)	12
Shorts, sport	Cricket	0.75x (0.42x to 2.18x)	1.16x (0.75x to 1.85x)	11

Spread across sports: 0.21 at the change against 0.38 and 0.25 where nothing changed (standard deviation of log ratios). Differences between segments are not established. Swimming and fantasy sports have the highest point estimates but the widest ranges, on 14 channels each; do not sell them as the biggest gainers. *Source: lift_by_segment.csv, segment_dispersion.csv.*

A17. 19 re-cuts of long-form put the rise at +46% to +85%; comparing with Shorts gives +78% to +109% (1 of 2)

Variant	Views per video	Typical video
Primary (balanced channel weights)	1.74x (1.60x to 1.94x)	2.13x (1.96x to 2.31x)
Weights = pre-group video count (version 1 primary)	1.77x (1.60x to 1.94x)	2.43x (2.03x to 3.10x)
Equal weight per channel	1.46x (1.27x to 1.78x)	2.03x (1.91x to 2.15x)
Poisson (PPML) with channel fixed effects, level views	1.74x (1.60x to 1.91x)	n/a
Post starts 2026-08-24 (no buffer)	1.72x (1.58x to 1.91x)	2.09x (1.92x to 2.28x)
Post starts 2026-08-27	1.78x (1.61x to 1.98x)	2.17x (2.00x to 2.37x)
Post starts 2026-09-07	1.78x (1.63x to 1.98x)	2.13x (1.97x to 2.32x)
Age window 27-31 days	1.71x (1.58x to 1.86x)	2.10x (1.95x to 2.28x)
Age window 28.5-29.5 days	1.74x (1.57x to 1.93x)	2.19x (1.98x to 2.43x)
Age window 20-28 days (post readings about 2 days younger)	1.55x (1.24x to 1.93x)	2.02x (1.81x to 2.31x)
Age window 26-28 days (ages matched)	1.54x (1.27x to 1.89x)	1.98x (1.74x to 2.34x)
Pre group: published 2026-07-01 or later only	1.69x (1.53x to 1.90x)	2.06x (1.91x to 2.22x)
Post group: published 2026-09-14 or later only	1.66x (1.49x to 1.88x)	2.06x (1.89x to 2.27x)
Drop readings stamped before ingestion	1.74x (1.60x to 1.94x)	2.13x (1.96x to 2.31x)
Drop long-form at or under 60 seconds	1.73x (1.59x to 1.92x)	2.12x (1.97x to 2.30x)

Source: sensitivity.csv.

A17. 19 re-cuts of long-form put the rise at +46% to +85%; comparing with Shorts gives +78% to +109% (2 of 2)

Variant	Views per video	Typical video
Drop durations over 1 day or null	1.74x (1.60x to 1.94x)	2.13x (1.96x to 2.31x)
Post group uses only earlier (prev) readings, like the pre group	1.76x (1.59x to 1.95x)	2.14x (1.99x to 2.32x)
Drop top 1% channels by pre views	1.85x (1.66x to 2.07x)	2.14x (1.96x to 2.33x)
Drop the one channel with the largest share of the version-1 numerator	1.74x (1.59x to 1.92x)	2.12x (1.97x to 2.31x)
Long-form / shorts ratio, channels with both (diff-in-diff; windows differ)	2.09x (1.60x to 2.82x)	2.33x (2.08x to 2.60x)
same, without the dominant Shorts channel	1.78x (1.56x to 2.04x)	2.33x (2.07x to 2.61x)

19 cuts of long-form against itself give +46% to +85%. The two rows comparing long-form with Shorts give +78% and +109%. *Source: sensitivity.csv.*

A18. Last season's videos barely moved in central models, so most 2025 baseline views are old-count. Modeled uplift for 2025 videos: 0.6% to 2.4% in two central scenarios; timestamp bounds span 0.3% to 25.3%

Videos	Stored views	Flat-rate scenario	Even-spread scenario	Widest the timestamps allow
Published Aug 24, 2026 or later	3,676,114,016	+74.4%	+74.4%	+74.4%
Published Jul 26 to Aug 23, 2026	1,030,638,645	+4.2%	+30.7%	+2.9% to +74.3%
Published Jan 1 to Jul 25, 2026	7,775,150,749	+1.6%	+6.1%	+0.4% to +40.0%
Published in 2025	4,481,464,795	+0.6%	+2.4%	+0.3% to +25.3%
All long-form	16,963,368,205	+11.6%	+16.2%	+10.7% to +43.4%

How much of each group's stored views the new count added. Every column assumes one factor (1.74x) for every view after the change. Older videos earned most of their views before it. *Source: stock_translation.csv, review_checks.csv.*